Rational Number Project

Fraction Lessons for the Middle Grades

Level 1

by

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Merlyn Behr was a founding member of the Rational Number Project. He developed the first draft of the fraction materials that was used in the initial research with children. His insight into children's learning, and his thoughtful analyses if students' thinking are an integral part of this curriculum.

These Lessons are dedicated to Merlyn Behr. After a long and illustrious career in mathematics education, he passed away in February, 1995.

The authors would like to acknowledge the important contributions made by the fourth- and fifth-grade teachers in the Rosemount-Apple Valley, MN school district who participated in the pilot study of these materials. Their suggestions for improving the lesson have been incorporated into the materials. The quality of these lessons is due in part the input these teachers provided.